

Purpose of Road Markings

Road markings guide traffic flow, indicate lane boundaries, and provide rules about overtaking, parking, and stopping. Understanding them is essential for safe driving.

White Line Markings

- **Solid White Line (single)** — Do not cross or straddle this line. Separates traffic flowing in the same direction. Stay in your lane.
- **Broken White Line (dashed)** — You may cross this line to overtake or change lanes when safe to do so.
- **Double Solid White Lines** — Absolutely no crossing from either direction. No overtaking allowed at all. This indicates a high-risk zone such as blind curves or hilltops.
- **Solid Line with Broken Line (combination)** — If the broken line is on your side, you may cross to overtake. If the solid line is on your side, you must not cross.

Yellow Line Markings

- **Single Yellow Line** — No parking during restricted hours (check nearby signs for specific times). Short stopping to pick up or drop off passengers may be allowed.
- **Double Yellow Lines** — No parking or stopping at any time.
- **Yellow Zigzag Lines** — No parking or stopping. Usually found near bus stops, pedestrian crossings, and emergency access areas.
- **Yellow Box Junction** — Do not enter the box unless your exit is clear. Blocking the box is an offense.

Other Important Markings

- **Stop Line** — Solid white line across your lane at a junction. You must stop behind this line. Your vehicle must not cross it when the light is red.
- **Give Way Line (broken line across lane)** — You must slow down and give way to traffic on the main road.
- **Pedestrian Crossing (Zebra)** — Black and white stripes across the road. You must stop for pedestrians who are on or about to step onto the crossing.
- **Chevron Markings (diagonal stripes)** — Areas marked with diagonal white lines bordered by solid lines. Do not enter this area — it separates traffic or provides a buffer zone.

- **Directional Arrows** — Arrows painted on the road surface indicate which direction you must travel in that lane. Follow them accordingly.
- **Speed Limit Markings** — Speed numbers painted on the road surface serve as reminders of the speed limit.
- **Rumble Strips** — Raised or grooved patterns on the road surface that create vibration and noise to alert drivers (common before toll plazas and sharp curves).

Key Rules

- **Never overtake across double solid white lines**
- **Always stop behind the stop line at traffic lights**
- **Yellow markings relate to parking and stopping restrictions**
- **Follow directional arrows painted on the road**

Driving Action Plan (PTP)

Before and during every driving maneuver, follow the PTP sequence:

- **P — Position (Kedudukan):** Ensure your vehicle is in the correct lane and position for the intended maneuver. Check mirrors.
- **T — Speed / Kelajuan (Tukar Kelajuan):** Adjust your speed appropriately. Slow down for turns, speed up for merging.
- **P — Gear / Pecutan (Pindah Gear):** Select the appropriate gear for the speed and road conditions. Downshift before corners, upshift on straights.

The CITO Concept (Hazard Identification)

- **C — Concentrate (Tumpukan Perhatian):** Keep full attention on the road. No mobile phone use. No eating or drinking while driving. Stay alert.
- **I — Identify (Kenal Pasti):** Spot potential hazards early — other vehicles, pedestrians, road conditions, weather changes, unexpected obstacles.
- **T — Think (Fikir):** Assess the risk level and decide on the safest course of action. What could go wrong? What is the escape route?
- **O — Organize (Susun Atur):** Execute your plan — change speed, position, signal, or stop as needed.

Safe Following Distance (2-Second Rule)

- Maintain at least a **2-second gap** behind the vehicle in front under normal conditions
- In wet conditions, increase to **4 seconds**
- In heavy rain or fog, increase to **6 seconds or more**
- How to measure: Pick a fixed point (lamp post, sign). When the vehicle ahead passes it, count "one thousand and one, one thousand and two." You should not reach the point before finishing.
- When following large vehicles (lorries, buses), increase the distance further as they block your view

Mirror Usage (MSM Routine)

- **M — Mirror:** Check your rearview and side mirrors
- **S — Signal:** Indicate your intention
- **M — Maneuver:** Carry out the action

- Check mirrors every 5 to 8 seconds during normal driving
- Always check mirrors before: changing lanes, turning, overtaking, slowing down, stopping

Signaling

- Signal **early enough** to give other road users time to react — at least 30 meters before turning
- Signal before changing lanes, not during
- Cancel your signal after completing the maneuver
- Check that your signal does not confuse other road users

Road Priority — Visual Examples

Study these junction scenarios to understand who has right of way:

 Roundabout Priority	 Roundabout Lanes	 T-Junction Priority	 Junction Priority
 Right of Way	 Intersection Rules	 Turn Priority	 Lane Position

Key Signs for Safe Driving

 Give Way	 Stop	 No Overtaking	 Speed Limit
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Lane Discipline

- Stay in the left lane unless overtaking on multi-lane roads
- Return to the left lane after overtaking
- Do not straddle lane markings
- Use the correct lane for your intended direction at junctions
- On expressways, the right lane is for overtaking only

Traffic Light Colors

- **Red light** — STOP. You must stop behind the stop line. Do not creep forward or enter the junction.
- **Amber (yellow) light** — CAUTION. Stop if you can do so safely. Only proceed if you are too close to stop safely.
- **Green light** — GO. You may proceed if the way is clear. Check for pedestrians and other vehicles before moving.

Traffic Light Sequence

The standard traffic light sequence in Malaysia is:

- **Red** → **Red + Amber** (prepare to go) → **Green** (go) → **Amber** (prepare to stop) → **Red** (stop)
- The red + amber combination means the light is about to turn green — prepare to move but do not go yet

Flashing Lights

- **Flashing red light** — Treat as a STOP sign. Come to a complete stop, check that the way is clear, then proceed.
- **Flashing amber light** — Proceed with caution. Slow down and be prepared to stop if necessary.

Green Arrow Signals

- A **green arrow** means you may go only in the direction the arrow points
- You must not turn in any other direction, even if the main light is green
- A green arrow with a red light means only traffic moving in the arrow direction may proceed

When Traffic Lights Are Not Working

- Treat the junction as an **uncontrolled junction**
- Give way to traffic coming from your **right**
- Proceed with extreme caution, looking in all directions
- If a police officer is present, follow their directions instead

Pedestrian Crossing Lights

- **Pelican crossing** — Pedestrian-operated crossing with traffic lights. A flashing amber light for drivers means give way to pedestrians still on the crossing, but you may proceed if the crossing is clear.
- **Puffin crossing** — Similar to pelican crossing but uses sensors to detect pedestrians. The light stays red until pedestrians have cleared the crossing.

Key Rules at Traffic Lights

- Always stop behind the **stop line** when the light is red — do not creep forward
- Do not enter a junction if your exit is not clear, even if the light is green (avoid blocking the junction)
- Running a red light carries **10 demerit points** and a fine
- Be prepared to stop when you see an amber light — do not accelerate to beat the light